

Goodness, in this research, is not mainly “being nice” or “doing good deeds.” It is a deep inner quality of the person that comes from God, reshapes the inside, and then naturally shows itself in a life that is just, kind, and humble.

### 1. Where goodness starts

The study begins with God, not with us. It notices verses like “You are good and do good” which state that God’s very being is good, and his actions flow out of that. Being-good comes first; doing-good follows.

God’s goodness is described as part of who he is, not something he occasionally switches on or off.

When the Bible calls people to be good, this is always secondary and derivative: our goodness is meant to be a reflection of God’s own goodness.

Creation itself is declared “very good,” setting an original baseline of goodness before human failure enters the picture.

So the starting point is: goodness is God’s own inner character, and all real goodness in us traces back to him.

### 2. What goodness is in a person

For ordinary human life, the clearest “definition verse” the research highlights is Micah 6:8: “He has told you, O man, what is good.” Goodness here is unpacked as three things held together: doing justice, loving kindness, and walking humbly with God.

From across the passages, the study shows that goodness in a person is an inner moral quality; a shape of life that weaves justice, kindness, and humility together; and an orientation of the heart toward what is truly good.

A key finding is that goodness is never reduced to a vague “nice-ness.” It is concrete and costly: it acts justly, stays kindly loyal, and walks humbly with God in everyday decisions.

### 3. How goodness feels from the inside

The research keeps returning to how goodness is experienced, not only how it is defined. Verses like “taste and see that the Lord is good” and “it is good to be near God” are central.

It shows that goodness is something you can “taste” and “see” inwardly – it is known by encounter, not just by theory. Being near God is described as “good” in itself; closeness to him becomes the deepest good, even when outward circumstances do not change.

This true inner goodness leads to stable, resilient joy and well-being, unlike the fragile “gladness of heart” that depends only on success or honour and can collapse in a moment.

### 4. Goodness as Spirit-produced inner change

In the New Testament, goodness is explicitly listed as “fruit of the Spirit.” The study argues that this is not a loose metaphor but a precise description: the Holy Spirit produces a cluster of inner qualities (love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, etc.) that belong together as one renewed character.

Goodness here is an inner disposition the Spirit grows in a believer, not just a set of instructions they try to obey. It is closely tied to kindness; together they describe a Spirit-given posture of generous goodwill and moral firmness.

The Spirit does not bypass the will; instead, he awakens and strengthens “every resolve for good” so that the person genuinely wants and chooses what is good.

### 5. How goodness touches every part of the inner life

One of the most striking findings is how widely goodness engages the inner life – perception, thinking, memory, emotion, will, action, conscience, and relationships.

Goodness sharpens spiritual perception so we learn to recognise what is truly good and

what only looks good on the surface.

It trains the mind through wisdom teaching to value inner character above wealth, status, or sheer power.

It cleans up memory, leading us to remember God's faithfulness and to face honestly our own "not good" deeds instead of rewriting the past.

It deepens emotion, generating rooted joy and peace rather than brittle happiness.

It reorients the will and actions so that people actively choose justice, kindness, and humility instead of drifting.

It calibrates moral judgment and conscience so we can rightly call something "good" or "not good," including in our own lives.

It deepens relationships, equipping people to act with generous goodwill, to instruct, comfort, and serve others in healthy, other-focused ways.

Overall, goodness is an integrating power: it pulls the inner parts together into a coherent, morally healthy life instead of leaving them scattered.

## 6. Goodness toward God and others

The research traces goodness in three directions: from God to us, from us to God, and from us to others.

From God to us: God's goodness creates, promises, and faithfully fulfils what he has said, so that his people can say that not one good word has failed. His character is constant, even though our experience of his goodness depends on ongoing trust and relationship.

From us to God: goodness appears as trust, waiting, worship, and humble asking – a posture of dependence rather than self-sufficiency.

From us to others: goodness turns outward as doing justice, loving kindness, instructing and building one another up, and practical generosity. Real goodness given to others rests on goodness first received from God.

## 7. The shadow side: "not good" and distorted goodness

To understand goodness, the research also pays attention to its opposite: "not good" and false versions of goodness.

Prophetic texts describe people remembering "their evil ways and their deeds that were not good," leading to a painful but necessary inner revulsion at what they have become. This honest seeing is part of God's work of restoration.

Other passages show people calling evil "good" and good "evil," revealing that when the idea of goodness is twisted, moral evaluation and conscience themselves break down.

Narratives of fragile, self-centered gladness demonstrate how shallow and unstable false "goodness" is when it is built on pride, honour, or status.

## 8. What this means for ordinary believers

Putting it simply, goodness in this research is:

- Rooted in God's own character: "You are good and do good."
- Defined practically: do justice, love kindness, walk humbly with your God.
- Something you are invited to taste and experience, not just to affirm in theory.
- Grown in you by the Spirit as inner fruit, reshaping your heart, mind, emotions, will, and relationships.
- Expressed in real choices and habits, not only in feelings or intentions.
- Honest about the "not good" in us, using that painful recognition as part of God's transforming work.

You could think of goodness like this:

Goodness is God's own generous, steady, and just heart, received into my inner life by the Spirit, training me over time to see what is truly good, to love it, to choose it, and to live it out toward God and other people.

